Notes made to prepare for interviews, October 2026

Aladdin Studio from the outside

What public sources show, and why clients' AI tools could act on Aladdin under controls BlackRock's own business runs on

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Independent analysis from public sources with AI agents. Not produced, reviewed or endorsed by BlackRock.

Executive summary

Clients' AI tools could act on Aladdin under the same controls BlackRock's own business runs on.

Studio is Aladdin's developer and data layer: APIs and events, Aladdin Data Cloud on Snowflake, and developer tools[1]. Many data providers now offer AI tools a way to read their data[2, 3, 4, 5]. Aladdin's APIs also change the book. They post orders and assign compliance rules to portfolios. Access is granted per API, to read or to write. Compliance runs on each order by default[6].

Letting AI tools act will not stay unique; SimCorp and Clearwater have announced AI agents[7, 8]. What BlackRock can show is its own use. About 100 of its applications carry Copilot. Each Copilot tool matches an Aladdin API already in production[9]. Buyers say AI is changing what they build, and BlackRock has told investors that API calls will grow 17x by 2030[10, 11]. Part 3 sets out this direction, what would have to be true for it to hold, and four pieces of marketing work that would follow.

Limitations of methodology

Public material only: BlackRock web pages, the 54 API specifications inside 11 public `asdk_plugin` Python packages, about 125 recordings, SEC filings, procurement notices, GitHub and PyPI. AI agents gathered them; I checked every fact against its document. Some recordings are machine-transcribed, so names and jargon can be misheard. I have no internal product context, so some conclusions may be wrong.

How to read the receipts

Underlined text links to the document behind the fact. Each superscript number points to an entry in Sources, at the end of this document, giving the grade (P, S or T), title, publisher or speaker, and date where known.

■ **P** Primary document: a filing, a specification, a web page or press release, a procurement notice, or code on GitHub or PyPI

■ **S** BlackRock speaker on the record, with the name and title as the recording gives them

□ **T** Third-party report: trade press, or a third party's summary of a primary source

Part 1

What the public record shows

Aladdin is the investment platform BlackRock built for itself and sells to other institutions. Brennan Rosales, an AI Engineering Lead at BlackRock, put the scale this way at a LangChain conference in 2025. "BlackRock is the biggest user of Aladdin, but we also sell and support hundreds of clients globally across 70 countries." The organization is "around 7,000 people, with over 4,000 of those being engineers." They maintain "around 100 Aladdin front-end applications"[9]. BlackRock's technology services and subscription revenue was $2.0 billion in 2025, up 24 percent including Preqin, the private-markets data firm bought in 2025[12]. BlackRock sells Aladdin as four platforms that share one data language. They are the Aladdin platform, eFront, Aladdin Wealth and Preqin[13]. Studio is the entry point for people who write code[14].

What BlackRock sells

Exhibit 1. Of eight Aladdin products, Studio is the one for people who write code

Product	What it does	Main users
Aladdin	The front-to-back system for public and private markets[15], the same system BlackRock runs internally[9]	Asset managers, insurers, pension funds, banks
Aladdin Wealth	Portfolio risk analysis and proposals for advisors[16]. Its AI "auto commentary" tool launched in October 2025, with Morgan Stanley as the first client[17]	Wealth managers and private banks
eFront	A private-fund investment platform covering due diligence through cash flows and reporting. Preqin now sits inside eFront Insight[18], and private credit analytics were added on Preqin in May 2026[19]	Investors in funds and fund managers
Aladdin Studio	**The developer and data layer. It covers APIs and events, Aladdin Data Cloud, and developer tools[1]. BlackRock calls it "API-first" and names three users: "a professional engineer building new workflow applications, a code-curious portfolio manager extracting investment insights, or a data analyst automating reporting"[14]**	**Client engineers, data analysts, code-curious portfolio managers**
Aladdin Data Cloud	A managed data service on Snowflake that puts Aladdin and outside data in one place[20]. It is sold as an add-on to Aladdin Enterprise[21]. Richard Newman, General Manager, Aladdin Studio, calls it "part of Studio"[22]	Data teams
Aladdin Copilot	A chat assistant "now available to all Aladdin clients" that "will not give investment advice"[23]	All platform users
Aladdin Accounting	Investment accounting and performance[24]. Its public APIs cover configuration, valuations, lots and composites[6]	Asset managers and asset owners
Aladdin Provider	Connects custodians and administrators to a client's Aladdin. The providers pay BlackRock to use it[25]	Custodians and administrators

Source: BlackRock product pages[14, 15, 18, 20, 23]; BlackRock AWS release, December 2025[21]; Woodhead[1]; iShares prospectus[25]; the public specifications[6].

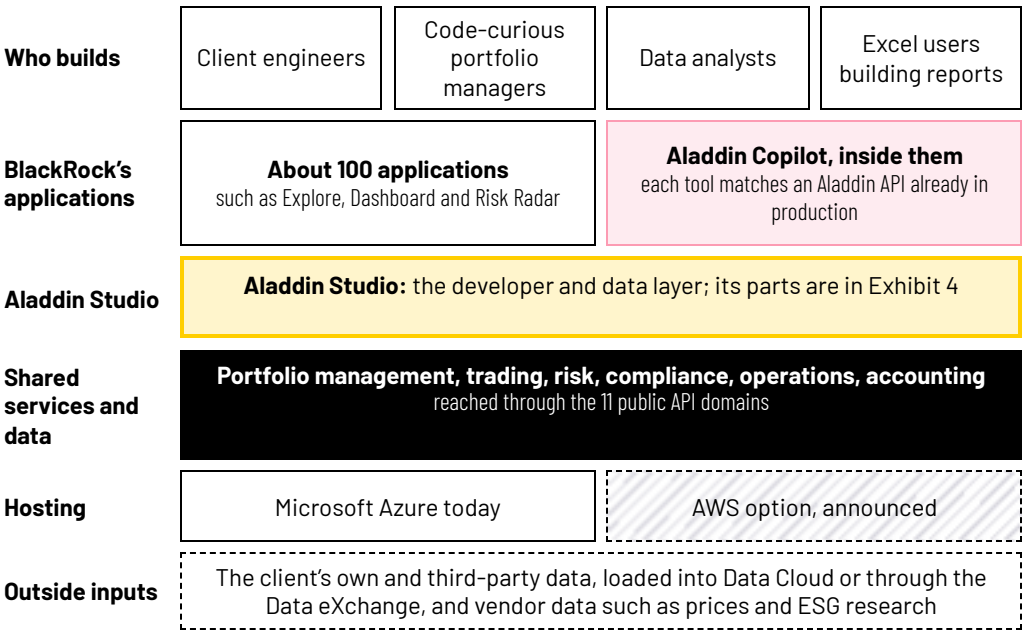
Exhibit 2 follows one trade through Aladdin, step by step, as far as the 54 public specifications describe it[6, 26].

Exhibit 2. The public APIs follow a trade from order to NAV

Step	Who acts	Product or application BlackRock names	API that covers it
1 **Order**	The portfolio manager. An order is "a directive from a portfolio manager to the trading desk to execute a particular investment decision" (Order spec)[6]	The Explore application: its "new what-if model" (Explore classroom recording) shows a changed portfolio beside the original[27]	`OrderAPI` v1 (stable). Posting an order takes `whatIf` and `runCompliance`. Its example statuses run "Open," "Compl Pending," "Authorized," "Active," "Booked"[6]
2 **Compliance check**	No one. The check runs automatically when the order is posted, because `runCompliance` is on by default. A violation record can hold an owner and a user's resolution comment. It gets a disposition when closed[6]	Rules "automatically monitor whether a fund adheres to a regulation, client mandate, or internal guideline" (ComplianceRule spec). The Level spec names the application "Aladdin Compliance"[6]	`ComplianceRuleAPI` and `ViolationAPI` v1 (alpha). Violations are "generated at time of the compliance breach" (Violation spec). A check that times out posts the order as "Compl Pending"[6]
3 **Trade**	The trading desk. Operations then confirms it, because "after a trade is booked in Aladdin, it needs to be confirmed with broker" (BrokerConfirmRouting spec)[6]	David Schneid, head of product management for Aladdin Accounting, describes the run as going "from that first order through the trade, through all the operation protocols into accounting without lifting up the pencil"[26]	`TradeAPI` v2 (alpha). A block trade carries its per-portfolio trades, plus `confirmedWith` and `confirmedBy`. `BrokerConfirmRoutingAPI` holds each broker's instructions for delivering confirms[6]
4 **Position in the IBOR**	The investment team, whose live book is the IBOR, the investment book of record. Richard Newman, Studio's general manager: "It does start with IBOR"[22]	Aladdin Data Cloud, where users "can access their Investment Books of Record (IBOR), Accounting Books of Record (ABOR) holdings" (Fivetran's blog)[28]	None of the 54 is a position API. Positions appear only as fields, for example a positions source in `PortfolioToolkitAPI`, collateral positions in `CollateralStatementAPI` and a violation's "underlying positions" (Violation spec)[6]
5 **Lot in the ABOR**	The accounting team. Daniel Shannon, BlackRock's head of outsourced platform services, says "we are data managers more than anything else"[26]	Aladdin Accounting, named in the portfolio-configuration specification[6]	`AborLotAPI` v1 (alpha). ABOR lots, the accounting book of record, are "retrieved from the ledger_a_summary table" (AborLot spec)[6]
6 **NAV**	Accounting, whose clients are "CFOs, they're controllers, they're heads of performance" (Schneid)[26]	Aladdin Accounting; each valuation carries an exception list[6]	`ValuationsAPI` v1, beta: valuations "generated for various processes at the portfolio/portfolio group level" (Valuations spec)[6]

■ Source: the public specifications named in each cell[6]; Newman[22]; the Explore training recording[27]; the Aladdin Accounting episode with David Schneid and Daniel Shannon[26]; Fivetran[28]. The specifications hold no position or event API. They do not say in what sequence steps 4 to 6 happen. The labels in brackets are each specification's stability label: alpha is the earliest, then beta, stable and sunset; Exhibit 5 counts them.

Exhibit 3. Where Studio sits in Aladdin



CONTROLS BUILT INTO THE APIS

Access set per API
Each API has its own access scope. A user sees only what their entitlements allow.

Compliance by default
The order API runs compliance by default and returns any violations.

A second approver
Dataset releases need a second check.

For illustrative purposes only. Every box is named in the sources below; the AWS option is announced, not live. The 11 domains are the packages of BlackRock's public SDK; the specifications also name Dashboard and Risk Radar. Controls as in Exhibit 14. ■ Source: Rosales and Vicente Valdez at 2:35, for the apps and Copilot[9]; a training recording, for Explore[27]; Woodhead at 4:49, for Studio[1]; the public specifications and SDK[6, 29]; BlackRock's Studio, APIs, ATX, ADX, Data Cloud and Aladdin Risk pages[14, 20, 30, 31, 32, 33]; the Data Cloud launch release[34]; hosting, Azure and the AWS release[21, 35]; data vendors, ICE and Sustainalytics[36, 37].

Exhibit 4. What Studio is made of

WHAT STUDIO OFFERS

APIs (Aladdin Graph)
Read and write Aladdin data. Every public specification's id starts `agraph.<domain>`

Event-driven workflows
Aladdin tells a program when something happens. No event specification is public

Aladdin Data Cloud
A managed data store on Snowflake, with Fivetran moving the data

Aladdin Compute
Hosted, ready-to-use Python environments

Aladdin SDK
Open-source Python library for login, retries and rate limits. BlackRock's plugin builder generates its 11 plugin packages from the specifications

Developer Portal and Data Dictionary
Catalog, guides, field dictionary, notebooks and samples, behind a client login

The APIs page also links Aladdin Tools for Excel and the Aladdin Data eXchange

INSIDE A CLIENT'S STUDIO WORKSPACE, AS THE PUBLIC SDK FILES NAME IT

Projects Personal or shared. OAuth applications and storage are set up under one

S3 storage integration File storage set up in a Studio Project, its bucket assigned to a user or project

Studio notifications Email or push alerts to a user, a Project or a Space

ADC Admin Center Studio's screen for managing Data Cloud datasets

Studio Compute Sessions where SDK code can run, as an alternative to a developer's local machine

API tokens and API applications Sign-in details for programs: a token, or an OAuth client ID and secret

Studio UI Studio's screens, where tokens, applications and storage are set up

■ Source: BlackRock Studio and APIs pages[14, 30]; the 54 public specifications[6], for the ids, the portal link and the Admin Center; the SDK README[29], for the SDK and the lower group; Naik and Kalish, for Aladdin Graph[38]; the plugin builder[39]; Woodhead[1], Goel[40], the Aladdin Risk page[31] and a BlackRock job posting[41], for events and the portal; Fivetran[28]; Snowflake's partner page, for Compute[42]; the developer portal[43]. BlackRock gives no count of pieces. The APIs page describes the catalog, guides, notebooks and samples but does not link them; the specifications link the guides to a portal behind a client login.

Exhibit 5. Two domains hold 127 of the 301 public API operations

Domain	Specs	Operations	Alpha	Beta	Stable	Sunset	Largest APIs by operations
Investment operations	15	**74**	9	4	2	–	PrincipalInterestFactor, CounterPartySettlementInstruction, MiscellaneousCashflow, CouponReset and 11 more
Analytics	9	**53**	–	–	8	1	RiskRule, RiskWorkflow, RiskException, RiskConfig and 5 more
Investment research	5	**41**	5	–	–	–	AnalystCoverage, Criterion, Watchlist, ResearchNote and 1 more
Platform	6	**29**	2	–	4	–	AdcDataset, UserGroup, User, UserGroupPermission and 2 more
Portfolio management	4	**28**	1	–	3	–	CIDWriter, Strategy, CIDReader, CashLadder
Portfolio	3	**23**	1	–	2	–	PortfolioGroup, RestrictedAsset, PortfolioToolkit
Data	1	**15**	–	–	1	–	SecurityCreation
Trading	2	**14**	1	–	1	–	Order, Trade
Compliance	4	**9**	3	–	1	–	ComplianceRuleAssignment, Violation, ComplianceRule, Level
Accounting	4	**8**	2	2	–	–	PortfolioConfiguration, Valuations, CompositeMembership, AborLot
Clients	1	**7**	–	–	1	–	EnrichedCapitalFlow
Total	**54**	**301**	**24**	**6**	**23**	**1**	11 domains, 11 PyPI packages

■ Source: the 54 Swagger 2.0 specifications inside the 11 `asdk_plugin` packages, version 2.0.0b3, on PyPI[6]. Counts are mine, recomputed from the files. The core `aladdinsdk` package adds four utility APIs (token, subscription, notification and a demo), not counted here. Alpha, beta, stable and sunset are the stability labels each specification carries (its `x-aladdin-api-stability` field), alpha being the earliest; the four columns count specs by label.

The specifications say more than Exhibit 5's counts: they show how the APIs behave. Posting an order takes `whatIf` and `runCompliance`, which defaults to true, and the response returns any compliance violations inline[6]. Ten specifications expose an endpoint for long-running operations, and 35 operations are flagged as long-running[6]. The SDK polls them[29]. Risk exceptions and Data Cloud datasets carry bitemporal fields, which record two time dimensions. Rule assignments and dataset releases name a four-eyes approval, a second sign-off[6]. Every request carries an application key and a second credential. That is an OAuth 2.0 token, a client key, or a user name and password[6]. OAuth scopes look like `trading.order_management.order.v1.Order:read`[6]. The client ID and secret come from the Studio UI[29].

What Studio is

I pulled about 125 recordings. Five BlackRock speakers in them describe Studio or its parts[1, 22, 40, 44, 45]. Exhibit 6 lists each with the title the recording gives. BlackRock's own definition comes from the head of Studio engineering, on Snowflake's podcast in November 2025.

> "So we think about Aladdin today as a platform and Aladdin Studio is essentially the user experience that allows people to think of Aladdin as a platform. It exposes everything Aladdin knows how to do as a set of APIs events. The Aladdin data cloud built on top of Snowflake takes all of that information that's generated through our analytics factory and inside of Aladdin and pushes that into Snowflake. And increasingly we're building a set of developer tools."
>
> — Dave Woodhead, Managing Director and Head of Engineering for Aladdin Studio, Snowflake Data Cloud podcast, published November 11, 2025[1]

Exhibit 6. Five BlackRock executives describe Studio or its parts on the record

Speaker	Title, as the recording gives it	What they add to the definition	Recording
Dave Woodhead	Managing Director and Head of Engineering for Aladdin Studio	Gives the three-part definition quoted above	Snowflake podcast, November 2025[1]
Richard Newman	General Manager, Aladdin Studio	Data Cloud is "part of Studio"; analytics APIs "releasing soon … all part of the Studio umbrella"	Never Done podcast, January 2025[22]
Diwakar Goel	Global Head of Data, Aladdin	Every transaction "via an event, via an API"; Data Cloud "within 15 minutes of latency"	Pensions webinar, 2025[40]
Kunal Khara	Managing Director and Global Head of Aladdin Product	Named "the Aladdin studio estate" as a 2024 focus, meaning programmatic access "at machine scale"	Awards interview, early 2024[44]
Jeff Miller	Managing Director, Global Head of Data Platform and Product Engineering	Data Cloud replaced "flat files … FTP and related transfers"	Snowflake video, May 2026[45]

Source: the recordings cited in the Recording column. Quotations are verbatim from the transcripts; three of the five are machine transcriptions, marked as such in the Sources section at the end of this document.

Khara, Newman, Goel and Woodhead describe ways for clients to reach Aladdin through code. Only Woodhead names every part, developer tools included[1]. Newman calls the Data Cloud and the analytics APIs part of Studio[22]. Goel says every transaction should be available to clients through an event or an API. He also describes a near-real-time data store[40]. Khara calls Studio programmatic access to data and reporting[44]. A 2026 job posting for a product director of Aladdin Studio Developer calls it "Aladdin's extensibility layer"[46]. APIs and data access recur across speakers and years, so BlackRock already has the core of a positioning for Studio.

Exhibit 7. Four speakers describe parts of Studio, and only Woodhead names them all

Speaker, date	What they said	Parts they name
Kunal Khara, early 2024	"More users are craving this ability to interact with our data, with their data, with reporting with dashboards on a programmatic basis"[44]	None by name. Programmatic access implies APIs
Richard Newman, January 2025	"Aladdin data cloud specifically comes in, which is part of Studio"; "those analytic APIs … That's all part of the Studio umbrella"[22]	APIs, Data Cloud
Diwakar Goel, 2025	"Every single transaction … via an event, via an API"; "a near real time data store"; exposing "the software and application that we're building"[40]	APIs, events, a near-real-time data store
Dave Woodhead, November 2025	"It exposes everything Aladdin knows how to do as a set of APIs events. The Aladdin data cloud built on top of Snowflake … developer tools"[1]	APIs, events, Data Cloud, developer tools

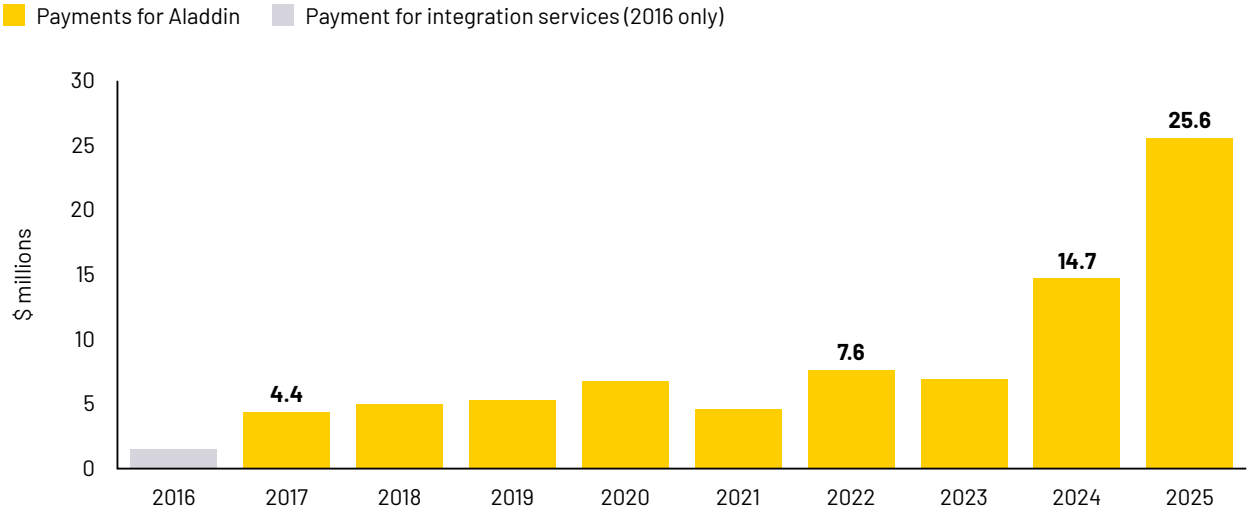
Source: the four recordings cited[1, 22, 40, 44]. Quotations are verbatim. Khara, Goel and Woodhead are machine or auto-caption transcriptions, marked as such in the Sources section at the end of this document. Goel does not use the name Studio.

Part 2

1. The public record of clients using Aladdin can serve as Studio's proof

BlackRock's Studio page names no client building on Studio[14], and a full-text search of SEC EDGAR finds no filing that mentions Studio[47]. Proof that clients use Aladdin, though, is public. On BlackRock's video, Hans Georgeson, then chief executive of Royal London Asset Management, credits Aladdin's Snowflake implementation[48]. JPMorgan Chase's proxy statements report Aladdin payments of $4.4 million to $7.6 million a year from 2017 to 2023, then $14.7 million in 2024 and $25.6 million in 2025[49, 50].

Exhibit 8. JPMorgan Chase's payments for Aladdin rose from under $8 million a year to $25.6 million in 2025



Source: JPMorgan Chase proxy statements (DEF 14A) filed 2017 to 2026[49, 50]. The chart plots each payment in the year it was made. The grey 2016 bar is a payment for integration services; the figures in the text start with 2017. JPMorgan is also a custodian, so the payments may cover more than a client license. In 2016 it said it was connecting to Aladdin for custody clients[51]. That 2016 report is trade press, not a JPMorgan or BlackRock document.

A second kind of record is code written by a client's engineers. In December 2025 an engineer at a client firm submitted two changes to the open-source SDK: URL rewriting and custom headers. Both are for firms that route Aladdin calls through an enterprise gateway. The BlackRock engineer who co-wrote the SDK's launch post merged them[38, 52, 53, 54]. Janus Henderson's 10-K says that in the third quarter of 2025 the firm chose to move its investment management system to Aladdin, "a complex, multi-year initiative"[55]. Public buyers add a third kind of record: procurement notices.

Exhibit 9. BlackRock won the tenders of three public pension bodies

Buyer	Year	Outcome
UK Pension Protection Fund[56]	2025	BlackRock won both parts of the tender, at up to £74.0 million, against the fund's estimate of up to £55 million[56, 57]
Nest (UK)[58]	2023	Nest chose BlackRock's Aladdin over six other bids[58, 59]
US Pension Benefit Guaranty Corporation[60]	2017 and 2023	BlackRock won an investment risk system contract both times, at about the same yearly price[60, 61]

Source: UK Find a Tender[56, 57, 58]; Nest[59]; USAspending.gov[60, 61]. The PPF notice gives BlackRock's Aladdin web page as the supplier's address[56].

None of this proof names Studio, which matters less than it seems. Studio is sold for building custom applications on Aladdin, so a buyer wants to know that another institution built on the platform and stayed. Proof from one firm counts even when the buyer is a different kind of firm. Public pension funds, and firms whose filings or tenders already name BlackRock, are easier to name in public. So they are the natural first candidates for a named Studio story.

> **What this finding suggests about direction.** A named Studio story can start with clients whose Aladdin use is already on the record.

2. BlackRock's growth story to investors runs through Studio, though it rarely says the name

BlackRock tells investors that API calls will grow fastest, without naming the product behind them. At its 2025 Investor Day it forecast four volumes to 2030. API calls across BlackRock and Aladdin led, with 17x growth[11]. Attributing them to Studio is my inference. I make that inference because API use is the activity the Studio page describes[14]. No executive said "Studio" on any of the 26 earnings calls from the first quarter of 2020 to the second quarter of 2026[62]. Outside the calls, the only investor-facing mention I found is a single line on a 2023 Investor Day slide[63]. BlackRock's 10-K says technology services fees are generally set by the value of positions on the platform or at a fixed rate. They can also depend on subscriptions, go-lives and support. The 10-K does not list API calls among the fee terms it names[12].

Exhibit 10. No BlackRock executive said "Studio" on any of 26 earnings calls, Q1 2020 to Q2 2026

Term	Mentions	Where it came up
Studio	**0**	**Never on a call. The only investor-facing mention found is one line on a 2023 Investor Day slide[63]**
Data Cloud	2	Q3 2022[64] and Q4 2024[65], where it was described as an add-on sold with Aladdin Enterprise
API	1	Q4 2021: "clients are really looking to use both data and APIs"[66]
Copilot	1	Q4 2023: "investments in Aladdin AI copilots"[67]
Citizen developer	0	Never
AI agent or agentic	0	Never

Source: third-party transcripts of BlackRock earnings calls, Q1 2020 to Q2 2026[62]. My tally. The non-zero counts add up to about four mentions in six and a half years. A zero means the term appears in no transcript; the non-zero counts are approximate.

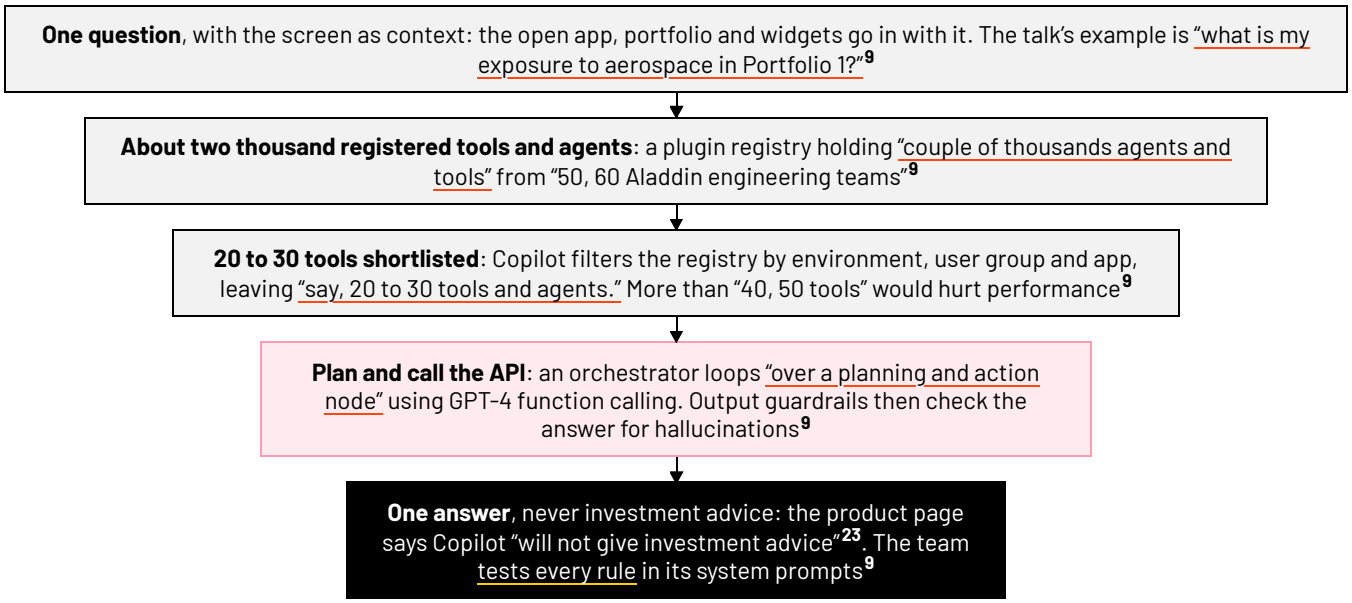
Much of the private-markets data BlackRock has been adding reaches clients through Data Cloud and Explore. BlackRock bought eFront in 2019 and Preqin in 2025. In September 2025 its private markets team described the result on a client webinar[68]. Investors "now have access to over 15,000 fund investments within eFront Insight" for benchmarking. Preqin indices "are also available today in Aladdin Explore and our Aladdin Data Cloud capabilities". And "over 10 different transaction types" were added to Aladdin, covering commitments, fundings, paydowns and PIK, so private credit loans are captured natively. The team said those were designed with BlackRock's own professionals and "our new colleagues from HPS"[68]. Private credit analytics on Preqin followed in May 2026[19]. Newman, the Studio general manager, names eFront data and Preqin among the data being added to Data Cloud[22].

What this finding suggests about direction. BlackRock projects API calls across BlackRock and Aladdin to grow 17x by 2030, the fastest of the four volumes it showed investors[11]. The private-markets data it is adding from eFront and Preqin is going into Data Cloud, which is part of Studio[22].

3. Aladdin's AI answers inside the login; data providers let outside AI tools reach their data

Aladdin Copilot, the AI inside the login, calls Aladdin's production APIs as tools. It draws on a registry of plugins, "couple of thousands agents and tools," built by Aladdin's engineering teams. The first way a team adds a tool is "to define a tool as kind of mapping one-to-one to an existing Aladdin API already out in production"[9]. Teams can also register agents of their own[9]. Studio "exposes everything Aladdin knows how to do" as APIs and events[1]. So I infer that Copilot and Studio use the same APIs. Microsoft's Adrian Crockett made the dependence plain on BlackRock's podcast: "There's no copilot without plug-ins"[69]. On the data side, a BlackRock product leader says the team is making sure "the data model itself is structured for agentic use cases"[70].

Exhibit 11. Copilot answers a question by picking from about two thousand tools and agents, then calling production Aladdin APIs



Source: Rosales and Valdez at LangChain Interrupt 2025[9]; the Copilot page[23]. The tool counts are the speakers' own approximations; the talk is a machine transcription, marked as such in the Sources section.

Exhibit 12 lists what the providers a Studio buyer compares have made public about AI access. Six data and cloud providers that Studio buyers also use offer a connector or an MCP server. Four system-of-record rivals have announced AI features or AI access to their data. LSEG had 90 customers connected by April 2026, according to a secondary summary of its results slides[71].

Exhibit 12. Of 11 providers a Studio buyer compares, ten have announced AI features or AI access to their data

Provider	What is public	Receipt
System-of-record rivals		
SimCorp	Agent Launchpad, announced in 2026, is to offer prebuilt AI agents and let clients build their own on SimCorp One's data layer	SimCorp news[7]
Arcesium	Arcesium added AI features to Aquata, including an MCP server that connects outside AI tools to client data, and launched an AI platform	Arcesium press releases[72, 73]
Clearwater	Clearwater announced CWAN GenAI, with more than 800 AI agents for clients, in November 2025	Clearwater press release[8]
Bloomberg	Bloomberg launched an MCP server for licensed data in September 2026	Bloomberg press release[74]
Data and cloud providers		
FactSet	FactSet runs an MCP server for its data and calls it the first in its market	FactSet press release[3]
LSEG	LSEG has announced a collaboration with Anthropic and an MCP server. It had 90 customers connected by April 2026	LSEG press release[2]; Investing.com summary[71]
MSCI	MSCI offers "AI connectors" to its proprietary data	MSCI press release[4]
S&P Global	S&P Global added Credit Ratings to its AI Data Portal in September 2026	S&P Global press release[75]
Snowflake	Snowflake documents an MCP server for Cortex Agents	Snowflake documentation[5]
Databricks	Databricks documents managed MCP servers	Databricks documentation[76]
Aladdin, for comparison		
Aladdin	**A Forward Deploy Engineer posting for Aladdin Data names "Model Context Protocol (MCP), AI agents, and Copilot extensions"**	**BlackRock job posting[77]**

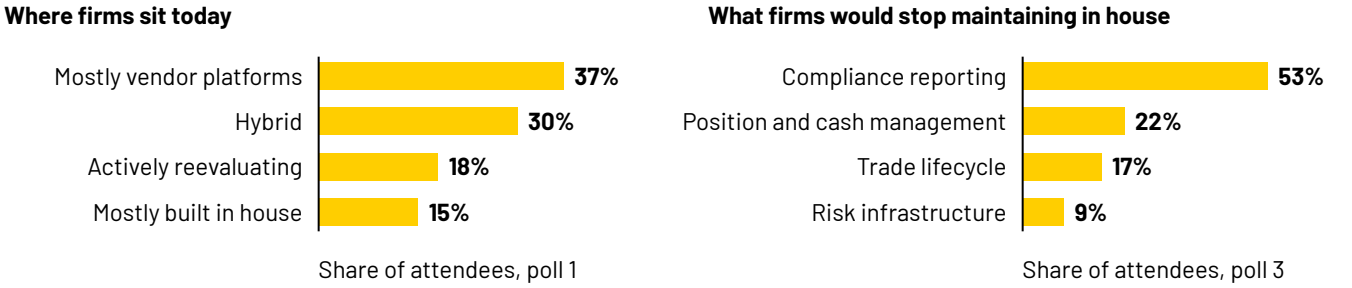
Source: the press releases, documentation and job posting in the Receipt column, as of October 2026. Aladdin has only a job posting that mentions MCP[77]. The LSEG customer count is from a secondary summary[71]. State Street is not listed because my sources show no AI feature it offers clients.

> **What this finding suggests about direction.** A public account of the Copilot plugin model would cover the production Aladdin APIs its tools call, which user groups may use each tool, and tested no-advice guardrails[9, 23]. That account answers three governance questions: who can call what, with which permissions, and under which guardrails.

4. At BlackRock's own webinar, two thirds of attendees said they run vendor or hybrid platforms

BlackRock ran a Build vs. Buy webinar for asset managers and polled the attendees. The first poll asked where firms sit today. 37 percent said they run "mostly vendor platforms," 30 percent run a "hybrid," 18 percent are "actively reevaluating," and 15 percent are "mostly built in house"[10]. The second poll asked what is driving the build-or-buy decision. "AI and data demands" led at 42 percent; cost and speed to market tied for second[10]. The third poll asked what they would stop maintaining in house. 53 percent chose compliance reporting[10].

Exhibit 13. Webinar attendees mostly run vendor or hybrid platforms and would stop maintaining compliance reporting in house first



Source: poll results read out on the Build vs. Buy webinar, from the replay's published captions[10].

> "What's the API suite that you have? Are you using connectors to Snowflake or to Databricks? And I think that that part of the RFP has become much more prominent."
>
> — Clark Schafer, Partner, Alpha FMC, on the Build vs. Buy webinar[10]

Alisha Sewdass, BlackRock's Head of Aladdin Solutions Engineering, Americas, gave BlackRock's side on the same webinar. She described the shift of the last two years. It is "to more of a modular approach where clients are looking for that backbone foundational data that supports both publics and privates workflows." That comes, she said, with "very, very robust APIs that manage the end to end life cycle of a transaction." Those APIs let clients build "their secret sauce rebalancing tools" on top[10]. On AI, she said, "you need that system of record that underpins anything that AI is built upon." She also said "the other layer that is almost equally important is a really defined system of work"[10].

Rivals sell the same model, a core platform with the client's own builds on top. SimCorp announced wins at AllianceBernstein in February 2026 and Pictet in May 2026. AllianceBernstein keeps its "specialized in-house technology," and Pictet connects its own tools to SimCorp One by API[78, 79]. BlackRock's own August 2026 insight page says the same: "Build vs buy is no longer a binary question"[80].

> **What this finding suggests about direction.** Buyers now ask in RFPs whether they can build on the platform. Studio is the right kind of answer.

Part 3

Directions to explore

The findings suggest that Studio could be presented as the place where a client's own AI tools act on investment data under the same controls BlackRock's own business runs on. BlackRock has said parts of this. It sells Aladdin as the system it runs internally[9, 81]. Its speakers have said that the system of record underpins anything built with AI[10], and that the data model is being structured for agentic use[70]. I have not found it describe Studio this way.

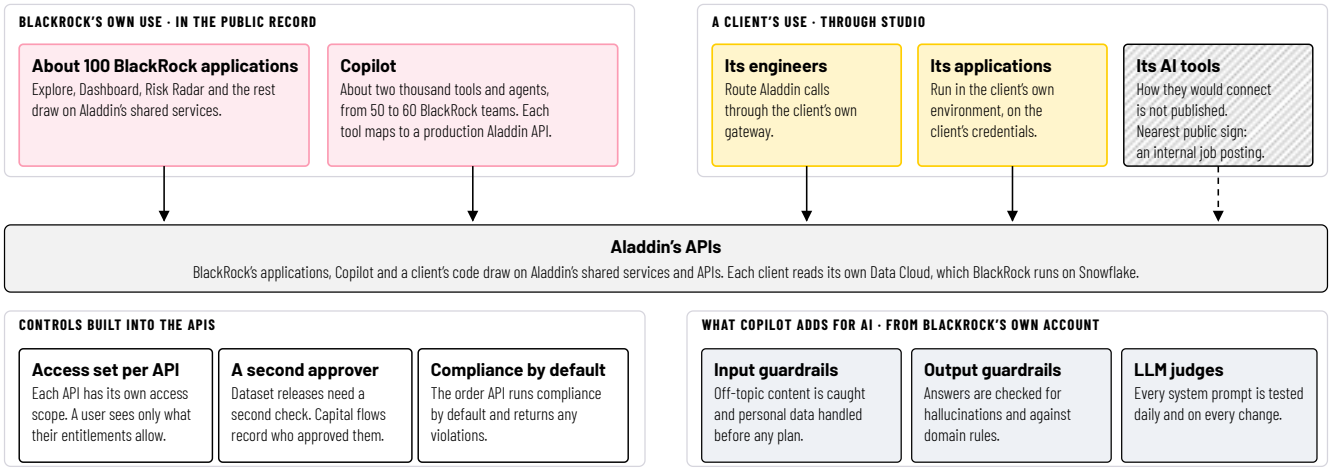
Letting AI tools act is unlikely to stay unique. SimCorp and Clearwater have announced AI agents, Arcesium an AI platform, and others will likely follow[7, 8, 73]. What BlackRock can show is its own use. About 100 of its applications carry Copilot. Each Copilot tool maps to a production Aladdin API. The team that owns each tool sets which user groups can use it[9]. Every order is checked for compliance by default, and Copilot's guardrails are tested daily[6, 9]. A client's AI tools would work under controls BlackRock already relies on for its own business. How those tools would connect is not public.

Buyers say AI is changing what they build. "AI and data demands" led BlackRock's webinar poll at 42 percent as the reason firms are rethinking what to build and what to buy, and buyers now ask about APIs and connectors in RFPs[10]. The poll did not ask whether clients want AI tools that act on Aladdin, and it gives no sample size.

The client base is large. BlackRock serves hundreds of Aladdin clients in 70 countries[9], and its technology services revenue was $2.0 billion in 2025[12]. A 2026 job posting for Aladdin Graph, the team behind the API layer, says it builds for BlackRock and over 200 institutions that rely on its technology[82]. BlackRock sizes Aladdin's addressable market at more than $20 billion[11]. It projects API calls to grow 17x by 2030, and AI tools acting for clients could become a large source of them[11]. Linking that figure to Studio is my inference. How many of those institutions run their own AI tools is not public.

Three things would have to be true for this direction to hold. Clients would have to want AI tools that act, not only ones that answer questions. Their risk teams and regulators would have to accept it, which likely means a person approves each action. And BlackRock would have to open its controls to tools it did not build.

Exhibit 14. BlackRock's applications and a client's code draw on Aladdin's shared services and APIs



■ Solid boxes are in the public record. The hatched box is not. The nearest public sign is a September 2026 posting for an internal data role that names MCP and AI agents[77]. The right-hand controls show how BlackRock governs AI on these APIs today, which is the model a client's own AI tools could follow. Sources: Rosales and Valdez[9], the Studio page[14], the Data Cloud launch release[34], the Copilot page[23], pull requests 52 and 53[52, 53], the SDK README[29], the public specifications[6], the Data Cloud page[20], Woodhead[1] and Fivetran[28].

Exhibit 15. Four pieces of marketing work to explore, in the order I would start them

	The work	What it is	How to know it worked
1	**An answer for RFPs**	A ready answer to "what APIs do you have, and can we connect to them": the APIs by area with their stability labels, how permissions work, how a client routes calls through its own gateway, and an answer on Snowflake and Databricks connectors, plus how a client's own AI tools would connect.	Time to answer the API section of an RFP; RFPs that score Studio; how many of those are won
2	**How a client's AI tools act on Aladdin**	A page on how a client's own AI tools could read data and take actions through Aladdin's APIs, under the same permissions, compliance checks and guardrails Copilot uses.	The page is published; RFPs and deal reviews get a clear answer on AI connections; API calls from client AI tools
3	**One client willing to be named**	One client story, cleared for the Studio page and the RFP answer: a public pension fund already on record, or a client whose engineers have contributed to the SDK.	Named clients sales can cite; deals in which one is cited
4	**A worked example: an AI-proposed rebalance**	A page and a demo in which a client's AI tool proposes a rebalance through the order API. Aladdin runs what-if and compliance on every order and returns any violations, and a portfolio manager approves before anything trades[6]. Sewdass names rebalancing tools as what clients build on Aladdin's APIs[10].	Meetings that open on this example; pipeline tagged to it; API calls from clients who build it

Part 4

What I could not see

Everything here was read from outside, which limits what this document can be sure of. Exhibit 16 follows a prospect's engineer through six steps, from first hearing about Studio to getting help. For each step it records what is public today and what a client receives after qualification. I could read the pages, unpack the specifications and read the SDK's code. I could not run anything, test what a client receives, or open the catalog and the API guides with their notebooks and code samples. Where this document describes those, it relies on what sources say.

Exhibit 16. What I was not able to see from outside, and what opens after qualification

Step	Public today	After qualification	Receipt
Hear	Podcasts, webinar replays, client videos and conference talks on BlackRock's site and partner channels	The invitation-only Aladdin Client Forum and the Solutions Engineering team	the Never Done podcast[83], the Big Little Questions video series[84], client story video[48], webinar replay[10], Woodhead[1], Rosales and Valdez[9], Client Forum page[85], Solutions Engineering job posting[86]
Read	The Studio page ("Create & automate," "Make Aladdin your own," "Align internally & externally") and the APIs page, which promises "dozens of Aladdin APIs"	The Developer Portal and the API framework guides	Studio page[14], APIs page[30], developer portal[6, 43], job posting[41]
See the catalog	The 54 specifications, but only by unpacking the 11 PyPI add-on packages	The API catalog and the Data Dictionary	asdk_plugin packages[6], APIs page[30], developer portal[43]

Step	Public today	After qualification	Receipt
Try	Nothing to run: no public sandbox or trial is offered	Studio Compute; an API token or an OAuth application "registered via Studio UI"; and the client's own Aladdin host to call	SDK README[29]
Build	The open-source SDK on GitHub and PyPI, with a detailed README, sample code and demo notebooks; the plugin builder	A client host and credentials, which the SDK needs for every call	SDK README[29], PyPI history[87], plugin builder[39]
Get help	Pull requests on the SDK, reviewed and merged by a BlackRock engineer; on the Studio page, "Book a meeting" and "Download the brochure"	Jupyter notebooks and code samples from the API guides	Pull request 52[52], pull request 57[88], Studio page[14], APIs page[30]

■ Source: the pages and repositories in the Receipt column, read with no account or login, October 2026. The After qualification column is what those sources say a client receives. I could not test it, because the developer portal opens only after a client login[6, 43].

The SDK is the one piece of Studio a prospect can install before any conversation. Its README documents three run modes: "a developer's local machine," "Aladdin Studio Compute sessions" and a test mode. It stores a prompted password in the operating system's credential manager. It carries settings for firms that consume "the Aladdin APIs via an enterprise API management platform such as Azure API Management"[29].

Exhibit 17. Investment platforms, Studio among them, open to developers mostly after a relationship

■ 2: Fully public or self-serve ■ 1: Partial or after sign-up or approval □ 0: None or blocked

Platform	Public docs	API catalog	Trial or sandbox	First API call without a contract	Sample code	Community or marketplace	AI connector	Call to action
Investment platforms								
Bloomberg	1	0	1	0	2	1	2	1
Aladdin Studio	**1**	**1**	**0**	**0**	**1**	**1**	**0**	**0**
State Street	1	0	1	0	1	1	0	1
Arcesium	0	0	1	0	0	1	2	1
SimCorp	0	0	0	0	0	1	0	0
Clearwater	0	0	0	0	0	1	0	0
Data and cloud platforms								
Snowflake	2	2	2	2	2	2	2	2
Databricks	2	2	2	2	2	2	2	2
LSEG	1	2	1	1	2	2	2	1
FactSet	2	2	1	0	2	1	2	1
MSCI	1	2	0	0	1	1	2	1

For the AI connector score: 2 means a connector that outside AI tools can use, such as an MCP server. 1 means one announced or in limited release. 0 means none, or an assistant that works only inside the vendor's own platform. For the Call to action score: 2 means a developer can sign up and start alone, 1 a trial or access request, and 0 sales contact only.

■ Source: my test of each platform's public pages[2, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 14, 29, 30, 72, 73, 74, 76, 89, 90, 91, 92, 93, 94, 95, 96, 97, 98, 99, 100, 101, 102, 103], no accounts or payments, October 8, 2026. Bloomberg and Clearwater may score lower than they deserve, because some of their pages blocked automated access.

Exhibit 17 puts Studio beside 10 platforms that a Studio buyer also deals with. It scores each from 0 to 2 on eight things a developer with no client relationship can reach. The pattern is each vendor's selling model. Investment platforms cluster low because they gate. At Aladdin, as at Bloomberg, State Street, SimCorp, Clearwater and Arcesium, a first API call needs a contract or a relationship. Snowflake and Databricks sell to developers directly and score highest. LSEG and FactSet come next. FactSet and MSCI allow a first API call only for licensed clients[89, 98].

About this document

This is an independent analysis compiled from public sources. The sources are BlackRock product pages, investor presentations, SEC filings, a fund prospectus, procurement notices, press releases and job postings. They also include public code and packages on GitHub and PyPI, other vendors' product and developer pages, blogs and trade press. The rest are transcripts of recordings and earnings calls with BlackRock speakers. BlackRock did not produce, review or endorse this analysis. Facts are as of October 19, 2026, unless an exhibit gives another date.

AI agents pulled the pages, unpacked the packages, transcribed the recordings that had no published transcript or captions, and drafted the text. I checked each claim against the document or recording it cites.

Underlined text links to the document behind each fact. Superscripts point to the Sources section, which follows this page and gives each source's grade (P, S or T), title, publisher or speaker, and date where known.

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Sources

Sources are numbered in the order they are first cited. The letter after each number gives its grade. P is a primary document. S is a BlackRock speaker on the record, with name and title as the recording gives them. T is a third-party report. For recordings, each entry gives the minute and second at which each quoted passage begins. "Machine transcription" means speech-to-text software run locally on the downloaded audio. "Auto-captions" means YouTube's captions. Both can mishear names and jargon. Inside quotations, the only correction made was to the spelling of proper names the captions got wrong.

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